月亮上的脚印

从小镇的电视机到月亮的背面

Footprints on the Moon

From a small-town TV set to the far side of the Moon

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names, festival terms and words above HSK 5 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 月亮上没有风，也没有雨。有人说，留在那里的脚印†，即使过了几百万年，也不会消失。陈星‡第一次听到这句话的时候，只有八岁。说这句话的，是她的爸爸——一个只读过初中、在小镇§上修了二十年电视的男人。

电视里的月亮

2 那是2019年1月3日。那天晚上很冷，小镇上的街道很早就安静了下来，只有陈¶师傅的修理店还亮着灯。爸爸坐在灯下修一台旧电视，女儿坐在旁边写作业。陈星的小名叫星星，那年她上二年级。店里的小电视开着，正在放新闻。星星写着写着，就在桌子上睡着了。

3 突然，爸爸把电视的声音开大了："星星，快起来，你看！"星星马上抬起头。

† 脚印 *jiǎoyìn* footprint
‡ 陈星 *Chén Xīng* Chen Xing
§ 小镇 *xiǎozhèn* small town
¶ 陈 *Chén* Chen (surname)

There is no wind on the Moon, and no rain. Some say that a footprint left there would not disappear even after millions of years. Chen Xing was only eight the first time she heard this. The person who said it was her father, a man who had only been to middle school and had spent twenty years repairing televisions in a small town. 1

The Moon on Television

It was the third of January, 2019. It was a cold night. The streets of the little town had gone quiet early, and only Master Chen's repair shop still had its light on. Father sat under the lamp repairing an old television, and his daughter sat beside him doing her homework. Chen Xing's pet name was Xingxing; that year she was in second grade. The little TV in the shop was on, showing the news. As she wrote and wrote, Xingxing fell asleep right there at the table. 2

Suddenly Father turned up the TV. "Xingxing, wake up, look!" Xingxing lifted her head at once. 3

3 电视上是一张灰色的照片：地面上有很多大小不同的坑[†]，远处的天空是黑的。新闻里说，中国的“嫦娥四号”[‡]探测器[§]已经在月球背面[¶]成功着陆[*]了，这是人类第一次在月球背面着陆。

4 “月球的背面？”星星一下子清醒了，“月亮还有背面吗？”“当然有。”爸爸说，“什么东西都有背面。”“那我们为什么从来没看见过？”爸爸张了张嘴，想了半天，最后说：“这个……你明天问问老师吧。”

5 那天晚上，星星一到家就跑到阳台上去找月亮。可是天上一点儿月光也没有。爸爸说，这几天的月亮只是很细的一条，天快亮的时候才能看见。星星躺在床上，越想越睡不着：月亮的背面是什么样子？那里黑不黑？冷不冷？嫦娥四号一个人在那里，会不会害怕？

† 坑 *kēng* crater, pit
‡ 嫦娥四号 *Cháng'é Sìhào* Chang'e-4 lunar probe
§ 探测器 *tàncèqì* probe
¶ 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back
* 着陆 *zhuólù* to land

On the screen was a grey photograph: the ground was covered with craters of all sizes, and the distant sky was black. The news said that China's Chang'e-4 probe had landed successfully on the far side of the Moon, the first time any spacecraft had ever landed there. 3

"The far side of the Moon?" Xingxing was suddenly wide awake. "The Moon has a back?" "Of course," said Father. "Everything has a back." "Then why have we never seen it?" Father opened his mouth, thought for a long while, and finally said, "Well... ask your teacher tomorrow." 4

That night, as soon as they got home, Xingxing ran out onto the balcony to look for the Moon. But there was no moonlight in the sky at all. Father said that these few days the Moon was only a thin sliver, and could be seen only just before dawn. Lying in bed, the more Xingxing thought, the less she could sleep. What did the far side of the Moon look like? Was it dark there? Was it cold? All alone up there, would Chang'e-4 be scared? 5

嫦娥[1]和玉兔[2]

6 第二天晚上，新闻里又出现了一张照片：一辆小小的车从着陆器[3]上开下来，在灰色的土上留下了两道长长的印子。这辆小车叫“玉兔二号[4]”。星星指着那两道印子问：“爸爸，这些印子会被风吹掉吗？”“不会。”爸爸说，“我听人说过，月亮上没有风，也没有雨，留在那里的脚印[5]，几百万年也不会消失。”“那它们为什么叫嫦娥和玉兔呢？”爸爸放下手里的工具，笑了：“这个我知道。这些名字是从一个很老的故事里来的。”

7 这个故事是爸爸小时候听奶奶讲的。很久很久以前，天上有十个太阳，地上热得像火一样。一个叫后羿[6]的英雄[7]射下了九个太阳，后来得到了一种能让人长生不老[8]的药。

1 嫦娥 *Cháng'é* Chang'e, goddess of the Moon
2 玉兔 *Yùtù* the Jade Rabbit
3 着陆器 *zhuólùqì* lander
4 玉兔二号 *Yùtù Èrhào* Yutu-2 lunar rover
5 脚印 *jiǎoyìn* footprint
6 后羿 *Hòu Yì* Hou Yi, legendary archer
7 英雄 *yīngxióng* hero
8 长生不老 *chángshēng bùlǎo* to live forever

Chang'e and the Jade Rabbit

The next evening another photograph appeared on the news: a tiny vehicle had rolled down off the lander, leaving two long tracks in the grey soil. The little vehicle was called Yutu-2, "Jade Rabbit 2". Xingxing pointed at the two tracks and asked, "Dad, will the wind blow these tracks away?" "No," said Father. "I've heard that there's no wind on the Moon and no rain, so a footprint left there won't disappear for millions of years." "Then why are they called Chang'e and Jade Rabbit?" Father put down his tools and smiled. "This one I know. Those names come from a very old story." 6

Father had heard the story from his grandmother when he was little. Long, long ago there were ten suns in the sky, and the earth was as hot as fire. A hero named Hou Yi shot down nine of the suns, and later he obtained a medicine that could make a person live forever. 7

7 他的妻子嫦娥[†]吃了这种药，身体越来越轻，最后飞到了月亮上，住进了又大又冷的广寒宫[‡]。她为什么要吃那种药，故事有好几种说法；可是不管哪种说法，她都再也回不来了。陪着她的，只有一只白色的兔子。兔子每天在一棵大树下捣药[§]，人们叫它“玉兔[¶]”。

8 爸爸讲着讲着，自己也笑了：“我小时候，每到中秋节，奶奶就让我找月亮上的兔子。我找了好多年，一次也没找到。”“那你相信吗？”星星问。“小时候信。”爸爸说，“长大了就不信了。可是你看，现在嫦娥真的到了月亮上，玉兔也真的在月亮上跑。古代的人想了几千年的事，让我们这一代[*]人看见了。”

9 后来星星才知道，给探测器[#]起名字的人，想得非常认真。

† 嫦娥 *Cháng'é* Chang'e, goddess of the Moon
‡ 广寒宫 *Guǎnghán Gōng* Palace of Boundless Cold
§ 捣药 *dǎoyào* to pound medicine (in a mortar)
¶ 玉兔 *Yùtù* the Jade Rabbit
* 一代 *yīdài* generation
\# 探测器 *tàncèqì* probe

His wife Chang'e took the medicine; her body grew lighter and lighter until 7
at last she flew up to the Moon and came to live in the vast, cold Palace of Guanghan. Why she took it, the tellings differ; but in every version she could never come back. Her only companion was a white rabbit, which spent every day pounding medicine under a great tree. People called it the Jade Rabbit.

As he told it, Father began to laugh at himself. "When I was little, every Mid- 8
Autumn Festival Grandma would have me look for the rabbit on the Moon. I looked for years and never found it once." "So do you believe it?" Xingxing asked. "I did when I was little," said Father. "When I grew up, I stopped. But look: now Chang'e really has reached the Moon, and the Jade Rabbit really is running around up there. Something people dreamed of for thousands of years, and our generation got to see it."

Only later did Xingxing learn how much thought had gone into the names. 9

9 嫦娥四号[1]要在月亮背面[2]工作，可是月亮自己挡在中间，信号传不回地球。所以，科学家先发射了一颗卫星，把它放在月亮后面很远的地方。它像一座桥，把信号从月亮背面送回地球。这颗卫星叫“鹊桥[3]”。在七夕[4]的传说里，牛郎[5]和织女[6]被天河[7]分开，每年只有农历[8]七月初七[9]那天，成千上万[10]只喜鹊[11]会飞来，搭[12]成一座桥，让他们见面。星星越听越喜欢：“原来一个古老的故事，也能变成一座真的桥！”

1 嫦娥四号 *Cháng'é Sìhào* Chang'e-4 lunar probe
2 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back
3 鹊桥 *Quèqiáo* Queqiao (“Magpie Bridge”) relay satellite
4 七夕 *Qīxī* Qixi, 7th day of the 7th lunar month
5 牛郎 *Niúláng* the Cowherd
6 织女 *Zhīnǚ* the Weaver Girl
7 天河 *Tiānhé* the River of Heaven (Milky Way)
8 农历 *nónglì* lunar calendar
9 初七 *chūqī* 7th day of a lunar month
10 成千上万 *chéngqiān shàngwàn* thousands upon thousands
11 喜鹊 *xǐquè* magpie
12 搭 *dā* to put up, form

Chang'e-4 was to work on the far side, but the Moon itself stood in the way, 9
so its signals could not travel back to Earth. So the scientists first launched a satellite and placed it far beyond the Moon. Like a bridge, it carried signals from the far side back to Earth. This satellite was called Queqiao, the "Magpie Bridge". In the Qixi legend, the Cowherd and the Weaver Girl are kept apart by the River of Heaven; only on the seventh day of the seventh lunar month each year do thousands upon thousands of magpies fly to them and form a bridge so that they can meet. The more Xingxing heard, the more she loved it. "So an old story can turn into a real bridge!"

月亮的背面†

10 从那以后，星星的问题越来越多。月亮为什么总是用同一‡面对着我们？月亮上为什么没有风？玉兔二号§一天能走多远？这些问题，爸爸一个也回答不了。他修了二十年电视，知道电视的信号是怎么来的，却不知道月亮上的信号要怎么传回来。

11 有一次，星星问：“爸爸，月亮的背面是不是一直都是黑的？”爸爸想了想：“应该是吧。那边太阳照不到啊。”第二天下午，星星从学校图书馆借了一本书，一进门就喊：“爸爸，你说错了！”书上说，月亮绕着地球转一圈的时间，和它自己转一圈的时间一样，因而它总是用同一面对着地球。可是太阳会照到月亮的每一面，只是时间不同。我们看不见月亮的晚上，正是月亮背面被太阳照得最亮的时候。

† 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back

‡ 同一 *tóngyī* the same

§ 玉兔二号 *Yùtù Èrhào* Yutu-2 lunar rover

The Far Side of the Moon

From then on, Xingxing had more and more questions. Why did the Moon always turn the same face toward us? Why was there no wind on the Moon? How far could Yutu-2 travel in a day? Father couldn't answer a single one. He had repaired TVs for twenty years and knew how a television signal reached you, but he had no idea how a signal could travel back from the Moon. 10

Once Xingxing asked, "Dad, is the far side of the Moon always dark?" Father thought about it. "I suppose so. The sun can't reach it over there." The next afternoon Xingxing borrowed a book from the school library, and the moment she came through the door she shouted, "Dad, you were wrong!" The book said that the time the Moon takes to go once around the Earth is the same as the time it takes to turn once on its own axis, and so it always keeps the same face toward the Earth. But the sun shines on every side of the Moon, only at different times. On the nights when we can't see the Moon at all, its far side is at its brightest. 11

11 星星想起了那个看不见月亮的晚上：原来，那天嫦娥四号[†]在的地方，正是白天。

12 爸爸拿着那本书，看了很久。“是爸爸错了。”他说，“说真的，你越问，我越觉得自己知道得太少。”他停了一下，又说：“以后爸爸不知道的，你就去书里找；书里找不到的，你就自己去找。”说完，他好像有点儿不好意思，低下头继续修他的电视了。

13 从那以后，爸爸有了一个新习惯：电视里一有关于月亮的新闻，他就把声音开大，喊星星过来看。2020年12月，嫦娥五号[‡]的返回器[§]带着1700多克月亮上的土和石头，落在了内蒙古[¶]的草原上。那年星星上四年级，她把新闻里的每一个数字都认真地记在本子上。

† 嫦娥四号 *Cháng'é Sìhào* Chang'e-4 lunar probe

‡ 嫦娥五号 *Cháng'é Wǔhào* Chang'e-5 lunar probe

§ 返回器 *fǎnhuíqì* return capsule

¶ 内蒙古 *Nèiměnggǔ* Inner Mongolia

Xingxing remembered the night when there had been no Moon to see: so that day, where Chang'e-4 stood, it had been broad daylight. 11

Father held the book and looked at it for a long time. "Dad was wrong," he said. "To tell the truth, the more you ask, the more I feel how little I know." He paused, then went on: "From now on, what Dad doesn't know, look for it in books; and what you can't find in books, go and find yourself." Having said it, he seemed a little embarrassed, and he bent his head and went back to repairing his TV. 12

From then on Father had a new habit: whenever there was news about the Moon on TV, he would turn up the volume and call Xingxing over to watch. In December 2020, Chang'e-5's return capsule came down on the grasslands of Inner Mongolia, carrying more than 1,700 grams of soil and rock from the Moon. Xingxing was in fourth grade that year, and she carefully copied every number from the news into her notebook. 13

13 2024年6月，嫦娥六号[†]又从月亮背面[‡]带回了土和石头，这是人类第一次拿到月亮背面的土。那一年，星星已经上初中了。看着电视里那个小小的返回器[§]，她越看越激动，心里有一个想法越来越清楚：总有一天[¶]，我也要参加这样的任务。

十年

14 时间过得很快，一下子就到了星星高考[*]的那一年。离那个看不见月亮的冬天晚上，已经快十年了。成绩出来的那天，星星告诉爸爸，她想报北方一所大学的航天[#]专业。那所大学离家两千多公里。爸爸一听就不说话了。星星的妈妈去世得早，这些年，家里只有爸爸和她两个人。那天晚上，他一个人在店里坐到很晚。

† 嫦娥六号 *Cháng'é Liùhào* Chang'e-6 lunar probe
‡ 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back
§ 返回器 *fǎnhuíqì* return capsule
¶ 总有一天 *zǒng yǒu yī tiān* someday, sooner or later
* 高考 *gāokǎo* national college entrance exam
\# 航天 *hángtiān* spaceflight, aerospace

In June 2024, Chang'e-6 brought back soil and rock from the far side: the first time humankind had ever held soil from the far side of the Moon. By then Xingxing was already in middle school. Watching the tiny return capsule on TV, she grew more and more excited, and one thought became clearer and clearer: someday I'm going to take part in a mission like this. 13

Ten Years

Time flew, and all at once it was the year of Xingxing's gaokao. Nearly ten years had passed since that winter night when there had been no Moon to see. On the day her results came out, Xingxing told her father that she wanted to apply to the aerospace programme at a university in the north. That university was more than two thousand kilometres from home. The moment Father heard this, he fell silent. Xingxing's mother had died young, and for years there had been only the two of them, father and daughter. That night he sat alone in the shop until very late. 14

15 第二天吃饭的时候，爸爸终于说话了：“星星，学这个……是不是太远了？也太难了。咱们这儿，从来没有人干过这个。你去读师范[†]，以后回来当老师，不好吗？”星星没有马上回答。她知道，爸爸不是不相信她，而是怕她一个人在外面太辛苦。过了很久，她才轻轻地说：“爸爸，你还记得吗？你说过，书里找不到的，就自己去找。”爸爸没有说话。

16 那天夜里，爸爸在柜子里找到了一个旧本子。那是星星小时候的本子，上面画着歪歪扭扭[‡]的月亮，还写满了问题：“月亮的背面[§]黑不黑？”“信号怎么回来？”“玉兔[¶]会不会迷路[*]？”很多问题下面，还有她后来用笔写上去的答案。爸爸翻着翻着，眼睛就湿了。最后一页上，有一行大字：“长大以后，我要自己去月亮的背面看看。”

17 第二天早上，爸爸把本子放在星星面前。

† 师范 *shīfàn* teachers' college
‡ 歪歪扭扭 *wāiwāi niǔniǔ* crooked, wobbly
§ 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back
¶ 玉兔 *Yùtù* the Jade Rabbit
* 迷路 *mílù* to get lost

The next day at dinner Father finally spoke. "Xingxing, studying this... isn't 15
it too far away? And too hard. No one around here has ever done anything like it. Why not go to a teachers' college and come back here to teach?" Xingxing didn't answer right away. She knew it wasn't that Father didn't believe in her; he was afraid life would be too hard for her on her own, far from home. After a long while she said softly, "Dad, do you remember? You told me that what I can't find in books, I should go and find myself." Father said nothing.

That night, Father found an old notebook in the cupboard. It was Xingxing's 16
notebook from when she was small, full of wobbly drawings of the Moon and page after page of questions: "Is the far side of the Moon dark?" "How do the signals get back?" "Will the Jade Rabbit get lost?" Under many of the questions were answers she had written in later. As Father turned the pages, his eyes grew wet. On the last page was a line in big characters: "When I grow up, I'm going to go and see the far side of the Moon for myself."

The next morning Father put the notebook down in front of Xingxing. 17

17 “你小时候，每天晚上都问我月亮的事，问着问着就睡着了。”他说，“爸爸不懂月亮，可是爸爸懂你。这条路，你非走不可。去吧。”九月，爸爸送她上了去北方的火车。火车快开的时候，星星从窗户伸出头来，笑着说：“爸爸，你等着，总有一天[†]，你会在电视里看见我的！”

控制中心

18 又一个冬天的晚上，北京航天飞行控制中心[‡]的大厅里坐满了人。离那个在电视前睡着的晚上，已经过去了十五年。陈星[§]大学毕业以后，又读了研究生，后来成了一名年轻的航天[¶]工程师，负责探测器[*]和地球之间的通信。

† 总有一天 *zǒng yǒu yī tiān* someday, sooner or later

‡ 北京航天飞行控制中心 *Běijīng Hángtiān Fēixíng Kòngzhì Zhōngxīn* Beijing Aerospace Control Center

§ 陈星 *Chén Xīng* Chen Xing

¶ 航天 *hángtiān* spaceflight, aerospace

* 探测器 *tàncèqì* probe

"When you were little, you asked me about the Moon every night, and you'd 17
fall asleep in the middle of asking," he said. "Dad doesn't understand the Moon, but Dad understands you. This is a road you have to take. Go." In September, Father saw her onto a train going north. Just before the train left, Xingxing leaned her head out of the window and laughed. "Dad, just you wait. Someday you'll see me on TV!"

Mission Control

On another winter night, the hall of the Beijing Aerospace Control Center 18
was full of people. Fifteen years had passed since the night she fell asleep in front of the TV. After graduating, Chen Xing had gone on to graduate school and then become a young aerospace engineer, responsible for communications between the probe and Earth.

18 这是一次新的任务：一个新的探测器[1]要在月亮背面[2]着陆[3]，地点是以前从来没有探测器去过的地方。这一次，帮它传信号的，是一颗新的“鹊桥[4]”。

19 探测器开始下降了。大厅里安静极了，只能听到广播里的声音：“高度一千米……五百米……一百米……”就在这时，陈星[5]面前的屏幕[6]突然不动了——信号断了！一秒，两秒，三秒……她的眼睛一直看着屏幕，越等越紧张，手心里全是汗。旁边的老工程师轻轻地说：“别急，再等等。”到了第八秒，屏幕上的数字又跳了起来——信号总算回来了！几分钟以后，广播里传来一句话：“着陆成功！”大厅里一下子热闹了，有人站了起来，有人互相拥抱，有人高兴得哭了。

20 不久，第一张照片传回来了：灰色的地面，大小不同的坑[7]，黑色的天空。

1 探测器 *tàncèqì* probe
2 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back
3 着陆 *zhuólù* to land
4 鹊桥 *Quèqiáo* Queqiao (“Magpie Bridge”) relay satellite
5 陈星 *Chén Xīng* Chen Xing
6 屏幕 *píngmù* screen
7 坑 *kēng* crater, pit

It was a new mission: a new probe was to land on the far side of the Moon, at a spot where no probe had ever been before. This time, its signals would be relayed by a new "Magpie Bridge". 18

The probe began its descent. The hall was utterly silent; all you could hear was the voice over the loudspeaker: "Altitude one thousand metres... five hundred metres... one hundred metres..." Just then, the screen in front of Chen Xing suddenly froze. The signal had dropped! One second, two, three... Her eyes never left the screen; she grew more anxious the longer she waited, and her palms were wet with sweat. The veteran engineer beside her said quietly, "Don't panic. Wait a little longer." At the eighth second, the numbers on the screen jumped back to life. The signal was back at last! A few minutes later a voice came over the loudspeaker: "Landing successful!" The whole hall burst into life: some people stood up, some hugged each other, and some cried for joy. 19

Soon the first photograph came back: grey ground, craters of every size, a black sky. 20

20 陈星[†]看着照片，好像又回到了小镇[‡]上那个冬天的晚上。任务结束后，一位记者采访了她："您是什么时候开始对月亮感兴趣的？"陈星笑了笑："我是八岁那年，在我爸爸的修理店里，第一次看见月亮背面[§]的。那天晚上我问了他一个问题，他回答不了。所以，我就自己来找答案了。"

爸爸的电视

21 就在这天晚上，两千多公里外的小镇上，陈[¶]师傅的修理店还亮着灯。店还是那家店，墙上的电视却换成了一台大大的新电视。爸爸的头发已经白了一半，修东西的时候要戴上老花镜了。这天晚上，他没有修东西。店里坐满了邻居，大家都想在电视上看看星星。

† 陈星 *Chén Xīng* Chen Xing
‡ 小镇 *xiǎozhèn* small town
§ 背面 *bèimiàn* far side, back
¶ 陈 *Chén* Chen (surname)

Looking at it, Chen Xing felt as if she were back on that winter night in the 20
little town. After the mission, a reporter interviewed her. "When did you first become interested in the Moon?" Chen Xing smiled. "It was when I was eight, in my father's repair shop, that I first saw the far side of the Moon. That night I asked him a question he couldn't answer. So I came to find the answer myself."

Father's Television

That very night, more than two thousand kilometres away in the little town, 21
Master Chen's repair shop still had its light on. It was the same shop, but the TV on the wall had been replaced by a big new one. Father's hair had gone half white, and now he had to put on reading glasses to do his repairs. That night he wasn't repairing anything. The shop was packed with neighbours, all hoping to catch a glimpse of Xingxing on TV.

22 新闻里出现了控制中心的大厅，镜头从一排排电脑前慢慢走过。“在那儿！”爸爸一下子站了起来，指着电视喊，“第三排，左边那个，就是我女儿！她一笑，我就认出来了！”接着，电视里出现了女儿接受采访的画面。听到“我爸爸的修理店”这几个字，邻居们都转过头来看他。爸爸笑着笑着，眼泪就流了下来。

23 新闻里说的那些东西，什么“中继[†]”、“轨道[‡]”、“数据”，爸爸还是听不太懂。可是即使听不懂，他也一句一句听得很认真。最后，电视上出现了一张新照片：灰色的土上，有两道长长的印子。一个邻居问：“老陈[§]，月亮上的这些印子，会不会被风吹掉？”“不会。”爸爸说，“月亮上没有风。留下来的，就会一直留在那儿。”

† 中继 *zhōngjì* relay (of signals)

‡ 轨道 *guǐdào* orbit

§ 陈 *Chén* Chen (surname)

The news showed the hall of the control centre, the camera moving slowly past row after row of computers. "There!" Father leapt to his feet and pointed at the TV. "Third row, the one on the left. That's my daughter! The moment she smiled, I knew her!" Then the TV showed his daughter being interviewed. When they heard the words "my father's repair shop", the neighbours all turned to look at him. Father smiled and smiled, until the tears ran down his face. 22

The things the news talked about, "relay", "orbit", "data" and so on, Father still couldn't really follow. But even without understanding, he listened carefully to every word. Finally a new photograph came on: two long tracks across the grey soil. One of the neighbours asked, "Old Chen, those tracks on the Moon, will the wind blow them away?" "No," said Father. "There's no wind on the Moon. Whatever is left there stays there." 23

24 邻居们走了以后，爸爸关了电视，走到门口，抬起头来。这一次，天上有月亮——很细的一弯，安静地挂在西边。他想起了女儿小时候借来的那本书：我们看不见的那一面，这时候正被太阳照着。那里有他女儿的探测器†，也有一个小女孩十五年前的问题。爸爸看了很久，轻轻地笑了。

† 探测器 *tàncèqì* probe

After the neighbours had gone, Father turned off the TV, walked to the door 24
and looked up. This time there was a Moon in the sky: a thin crescent, hanging quietly in the west. He remembered the book his daughter had borrowed as a child: the side we cannot see is, at this very moment, in the sunlight. Up there was his daughter's probe, and a little girl's question from fifteen years before. Father looked up at it for a long time, and smiled softly.